

A FRAMEWORK IN CHAPTERS

Chapter Ten

Settler Colonialism

A warning chapter:

Genocide · Displacement · Assimilation

Settler Colonialism is the system by which foreigners invade a locale to extract existence from locals and enforce their own existence at the expense of locals. There is no adult form in Nigeria, but fledgling forms exist. This chapter studies Israel-Palestine, the United States, Australia, Canada, and South Africa as a warning of what those fledgling forms could become if they grow to adulthood and ascend.

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CHAPTER 10 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK

Settler Colonialism

This is a warning chapter. The framework's outline explicitly notes that there is no adult settler colonialism in Nigeria, though nascent and fledgling forms exist. The chapter studies other countries — Israel-Palestine, the United States, Australia, Canada, and South Africa — as a warning of how bad a system like this can get if it is allowed to grow to adulthood and ascend.

Settler Colonialism is distinct from Invasion (Chapter 9, which extracts resources) because Settler Colonialism extracts **existence** — the foreigner comes to replace the local, not just to extract from them. The framework's outline names three operations: **Genocide**, **Displacement**, and **Assimilation**. Each is a different mode of replacing the local with the settler.

A note on method. The Interpersonal, Disciplinary, and Structural sections take the naive approach — each triad described as if happening for the first time. The Hegemonic Domain section studies the Canon and Practice of Settler Colonialism in the ascended cases as a warning for Nigeria. The Nigerian fledgling forms are flagged throughout.

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 9. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. Where you see literal blanks (____), the framework is asking you to write yourself into it. This chapter's blanks are different: they ask you to identify the fledgling Settler Colonial forms in your own Nigerian context, so you can recognise the warning signs before they grow.

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SECTION 1

1. Definition: What Settler Colonialism Extracts, Enforces, and Removes

Settler Colonialism is the system by which foreigners invade a locale to extract existence from locals and enforce their own existence at the expense of locals. The foundational theoretical text is Patrick Wolfe's 'Settler colonialism and the elimination of the native' (2006), which argued that settler colonialism is a **structure**, not an event — it persists across generations, not as a single conquest but as an ongoing replacement.

Lorenzo Veracini's *Settler Colonialism: A Theoretical Overview* (2010) systematised the analysis. Veracini distinguishes settler colonialism from colonialism proper: the colonial power extracts from the colony and returns to the metropole; the settler power stays, replaces, and disappears the indigenous. Frantz Fanon's *The Wretched of the Earth* (1961), written from the Algerian revolution, supplied the political vocabulary: the settler makes the indigenous, the indigenous makes the settler, and the relationship is one of mutual exclusion.

Mahmood Mamdani's *When Victims Become Killers* (2001) showed how the Rwandan genocide was a settler-colonial residue — the Belgian colonial construction of Hutu and Tutsi as racialised categories, with the Tutsi treated as a settler minority over the Hutu indigenous majority, produced the conditions for the 1994 genocide. Mamdani's *Citizen and Subject* (1996) had earlier shown how South African apartheid was a settler-colonial structure, not a deviation from colonialism but its fullest expression.

For the Palestinian case, Edward Said's *The Question of Palestine* (1979), Rashid Khalidi's *The Hundred Years' War on Palestine* (2020), and Ilan Pappé's *The Ethnic Cleansing of Palestine* (2006) document the structure from its origins. For the North American case, Roxanne Dunbar-Ortiz's *An Indigenous Peoples' History of the United States* (2014), Glen Coulthard's *Red Skin, White Masks* (2014), and Audra Simpson's *Mohawk Interruptus* (2014) supply the analysis. For the Australian case, Aileen Moreton-Robinson's *The White Possessive* (2015) is central.

1.1 The Three Operations

The framework's outline names three operations of Settler Colonialism. **Genocide** is the physical elimination of the indigenous — the massacre, the forced march, the starvation, the biological warfare. The Native American genocide in the 19th century, the Aboriginal Australian genocide, the Herero and Nama genocide in German South-West Africa (1904-1908), the Palestinian Nakba of 1948.

Displacement is the removal of the indigenous from their land — the reservation, the reserve, the Bantustan, the refugee camp, the open-air prison. The Trail of Tears (1838), the Australian reserves, the Canadian reserve system, the South African Group Areas Act (1950), the ongoing Palestinian

displacement from 1948 to the present. Displacement is the slower, more structural version of genocide.

Assimilation is the cultural elimination of the indigenous — the boarding school, the residential school, the Stolen Generations, the language ban, the religion replacement. The US boarding school system (1879-1970s), the Canadian residential school system (1831-1996), the Australian Stolen Generations (1905-1970s), the South African Bantu Education Act (1953). Assimilation is the most enduring operation because it works on the child.

1.2 What Settler Colonialism Extracts

Settler Colonialism extracts ten things. First, **land**: the indigenous land base that becomes the settler's property. Second, **territory**: the indigenous territory that becomes the settler state's jurisdiction. Third, **sovereignty**: the indigenous sovereignty that is extinguished and replaced by settler sovereignty.

Fourth, **the indigenous economy**: the indigenous economic system that is destroyed and replaced by the settler economy. Fifth, **the indigenous political structure**: the indigenous political system that is destroyed and replaced by the settler state. Sixth, **the indigenous culture**: the indigenous cultural system that is destroyed and replaced by settler culture.

Seventh, **the indigenous language**: the indigenous language that is suppressed and replaced by the settler language. Eighth, **the indigenous religion**: the indigenous religion that is suppressed and replaced by the settler religion. Ninth, **the indigenous body for forced labour**: the indigenous body that is put to work for the settler economy. Tenth, **the indigenous child for assimilation**: the indigenous child that is taken from the family and raised as settler.

1.3 What Settler Colonialism Enforces

Settler Colonialism enforces eight standards. First, **settler jurisdiction**: the settler state's law applies on indigenous land. Second, the **settler property regime**: the settler's private property in land replaces the indigenous communal tenure. Third, **settler language**: the settler language is the language of education, government, and commerce.

Fourth, **settler religion**: the settler religion is the religion of public life. Fifth, **settler education**: the settler school replaces the indigenous education. Sixth, **settler family structure**: the settler nuclear family replaces the indigenous extended family. Seventh, **settler hygiene**: the settler's standards of cleanliness, dress, and bodily comportment replace the indigenous.

Eighth, **settler temporal order**: the settler's calendar, clock, and week replace the indigenous calendar and seasonal cycle. Each standard is enforced by the settler state, by the settler church, by the settler school, and by the triads below.

1.4 What Options Settler Colonialism Removes

Concretely, Settler Colonialism removes the option to remain on ancestral land. The indigenous person who would rather stay on the land of their ancestors is removed — by force if necessary. The Palestinian who would rather stay in their village in 1948 is driven out. The Native American who would rather stay on their ancestral land in the 1830s is marched to Oklahoma.

It removes the option to govern by indigenous law. The indigenous person who would rather have their disputes governed by indigenous law is forced into the settler court. It removes the option to speak the indigenous language. The indigenous child who would rather speak their language at school is beaten for it. The Canadian residential school child who spoke their language was punished, sometimes with needles through the tongue.

It removes the option to practice the indigenous religion. The indigenous person who would rather practice their religion is forced to convert. It removes the option to exist as indigenous. The settler state's classification system — blood quantum in the US, racial classification in South Africa, the Israeli ID system — determines who counts as indigenous and who does not. The indigenous person who falls outside the classification is no longer indigenous. Each removal is enforced by the settler state, by the settler church, and by the triads below.

SECTION 2 · NAIVE APPROACH

2. The Interpersonal Domain

The Interpersonal Domain contains five enforcement triads and five extraction triads. Each is described here as if happening for the first time — no networks, no residues, no Canon. The examples are drawn from the studied cases (Israel-Palestine, US, Australia, Canada, South Africa) because Nigeria has no adult Settler Colonialism. The triads are described so that Nigerian readers can recognise the fledgling forms in their own context.

3.1 Enforcement Triad: Settler Jurisdiction Standard

The enforcer is the settler state official who demands the indigenous submit to settler law. The Israeli military governor who demands the Palestinian apply for a permit. The US Bureau of Indian Affairs official who demands the Native American nation submit to federal law. The Australian state Aboriginal affairs officer who demands the Aboriginal community submit to state law. The South African Bantu Affairs commissioner who demands the Black South African submit to the pass laws.

The enforcement is performed by direct demand, by the permit system, by the pass law, by the ID system, by the criminalisation of indigenous law, or by military force. The subject conforms by submitting — the indigenous applies for the permit, carries the pass, shows the ID, accepts the settler court's jurisdiction.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Palestinian who is required to have a permit to farm their own land loses the option to farm without settler permission, which is to say, loses the option to livelihood. The Native American nation that is required to submit its treaties to federal court loses the option to self-determination. The Aboriginal Australian who is required to live where the state directs loses the option to choose their own community.

The witness is the settler who watches the jurisdiction enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves benefit from the settler jurisdiction and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler who lives on the indigenous land but does not personally command the jurisdiction enforcement — the Israeli settler in the West Bank settlement, the US citizen on former Native American land.

3.2 Enforcement Triad: Settler Property Regime Standard

The enforcer is the settler state official or settler individual who demands recognition of the settler's private property in indigenous land. The Israeli settler who demands the Palestinian leave the land that the settler claims. The US rancher who demands the Native American not cross the fence that encloses the rancher's property. The Australian pastoralist who demands the Aboriginal not enter the station. The South African white farmer who demands the Black South African not enter the farm.

The enforcement is performed by direct demand, by the fence, by the title deed, by the police, or by violence. The subject conforms by respecting the settler's property claim — the indigenous does not enter the fenced land, does not challenge the title deed, does not return to the ancestral land.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Palestinian who is required to respect the settler's title to their ancestral land loses the option to return, which is to say, loses the option to home. The Native American who is required to respect the rancher's fence loses the option to traverse their ancestral land. The Aboriginal Australian who is required to respect the pastoralist's station loses the option to ceremony sites that are now behind the fence.

The witness is the settler who watches the property enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves hold property in indigenous land and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler economy that consumes the products of the indigenous land without personally commanding the displacement.

3.3 Enforcement Triad: Settler Language Standard

The enforcer is the settler institution that demands the indigenous use the settler language. The US boarding school that beat the Native American child for speaking their language. The Canadian residential school that punished the First Nations child for speaking theirs. The Australian mission that forbade the Aboriginal child from speaking theirs. The South African school that required Afrikaans or English. The Israeli state that requires Hebrew for full citizenship.

The enforcement is performed by direct demand, by punishment of indigenous language use, by the school curriculum, by the government form, or by the labour market. The subject conforms by using the settler language — the indigenous child speaks English at school, the indigenous adult speaks Hebrew at the office, the indigenous elder speaks Afrikaans to the official.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Native American child who is beaten for speaking their language loses the option to their mother tongue, which is to say, loses the option to a cognitive and cultural inheritance. The First Nations child in the residential school loses the same. The Aboriginal child in the mission loses the same. The loss compounds across generations, producing the language death that the United Nations estimates has affected over 90% of indigenous languages in the settler states.

The witness is the settler who watches the language enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves speak only the settler language and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler culture that becomes the default culture through the language displacement.

3.4 Enforcement Triad: Settler Education Standard

The enforcer is the settler school that demands the indigenous child attend and learn the settler curriculum. The US boarding school that took the Native American child from the family. The Canadian residential school that took the First Nations child. The Australian mission school that took the Aboriginal child. The South African Bantu Education school that under-educated the Black child.

The Israeli school that teaches the Palestinian citizen of Israel the settler narrative.

The enforcement is performed by direct demand, by the compulsory attendance law, by the removal of the child from the family, by the criminalisation of non-attendance, or by the denial of employment to those without settler credentials. The subject conforms by attending — the indigenous child goes to the settler school, learns the settler curriculum, internalises the settler narrative.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Native American child taken to Carlisle in 1880 lost the option to their family, which is to say, lost the option to their childhood. The First Nations child taken to the residential school lost the same. The Aboriginal child taken to the mission lost the same. The South African child given Bantu Education lost the option to a real education. The loss compounds across generations, producing the cultural death that the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada documented in its 2015 Final Report as cultural genocide.

The witness is the settler who watches the education enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves were educated in the settler school and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler economy that receives the under-educated indigenous worker as cheap labour.

3.5 Enforcement Triad: Settler Family Structure Standard

The enforcer is the settler state that demands the indigenous family conform to the settler model. The US and Canadian states that took indigenous children from their families and placed them in settler foster care or adoption. The Australian state that took Aboriginal children (the Stolen Generations). The South African state that destroyed indigenous family structures through the migrant labour system. The Israeli state that separates Palestinian families through the permit regime.

The enforcement is performed by direct removal, by the foster care system, by the adoption system, by the permit regime, by the migrant labour system, or by the criminalisation of indigenous family practices. The subject conforms by submitting to the settler's family structure — the indigenous child is taken, the indigenous parent loses the child, the indigenous family is separated by the permit.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The First Nations child taken in the Sixties Scoop lost the option to their family, which is to say, lost the option to their identity. The Aboriginal child taken in the Stolen Generations lost the same. The Palestinian family separated by the permit regime loses the option to family unity. The South African family destroyed by migrant labour lost the option to a household.

The witness is the settler who watches the family enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves benefit from the settler family structure and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler family that adopts the indigenous child, the settler economy that receives the migrant labourer.

3.6 Extraction Triad: Land

The extractor is the settler who takes the indigenous land. The Israeli settler who claims the Palestinian land. The US rancher who claims the Native American land. The Australian pastoralist who claims the Aboriginal land. The Canadian settler who claims the First Nations land. The South African white farmer who claims the Black South African land.

The subject conforms by leaving, by accepting the displacement, by signing the treaty, by accepting the compensation (if any). What is extracted is tangible: land. The extraction transfers the land from the indigenous to the settler, with the indigenous displaced to the reservation, the reserve, the Bantustan, the refugee camp.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Palestinian who loses their land in 1948 loses the option to return, which is to say, loses the option to home. The Native American who loses their land in the 1830s loses the same. The Aboriginal Australian who loses their land loses the option to ceremony sites, to hunting grounds, to ancestral belonging. The loss compounds across generations, producing the landless indigenous that the settler state then treats as a ‘problem.’

The witness is the settler who watches the land extraction and says nothing, or who themselves hold land taken from the indigenous. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler economy that consumes the products of the indigenous land without personally commanding the extraction.

3.7 Extraction Triad: Sovereignty

The extractor is the settler state that takes the indigenous sovereignty. The US federal government that extinguishes Native American sovereignty through treaty violation and federal recognition. The Canadian federal government that extinguishes First Nations sovereignty through the Indian Act. The Australian state that extinguishes Aboriginal sovereignty through terra nullius. The Israeli state that extinguishes Palestinian sovereignty through occupation. The South African state that extinguished Black sovereignty through the Bantustan system.

The subject conforms by submitting to settler jurisdiction. What is extracted is the indigenous sovereignty — the right to govern, to make law, to adjudicate, to tax, to regulate. The extraction transfers the sovereignty from the indigenous to the settler state, with the indigenous reduced to a dependant of the settler state.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Native American nation that loses its sovereignty loses the option to self-determination, which is to say, loses the option to political existence. The First Nations that loses its sovereignty loses the same. The Palestinian people that loses its sovereignty loses the option to a state. The loss compounds across generations, producing the stateless indigenous that the settler state then treats as a ‘question.’

The witness is the settler who watches the sovereignty extraction and says nothing, or who themselves benefit from the settler sovereignty. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler state’s citizens who consume the products of the extinguished sovereignty without personally commanding the extinguishment.

3.8 Extraction Triad: Indigenous Economy

The extractor is the settler economy that destroys and replaces the indigenous economy. The US settler economy that destroyed the buffalo economy of the Plains Nations. The Australian settler economy that destroyed the Aboriginal hunter-gatherer economy. The Canadian settler economy that destroyed the First Nations fishing and hunting economy. The South African settler economy that destroyed the indigenous agricultural economy through the 1913 Natives Land Act. The Israeli settler economy that destroys the Palestinian agricultural economy through land seizure and water control.

The subject conforms by entering the settler economy — as cheap labour, as welfare recipient, as the unemployed. What is extracted is the indigenous economy itself — the means of subsistence, the trading networks, the knowledge of land and resource. The extraction transfers the indigenous economic capacity to the settler economy, with the indigenous reduced to dependence.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Plains Nation that lost the buffalo lost the option to subsistence, which is to say, lost the option to survival on their own terms. The Aboriginal Australian that lost the hunter-gatherer economy lost the same. The Palestinian farmer that loses their land and water loses the option to livelihood. The loss compounds across generations, producing the welfare-dependent indigenous that the settler state then treats as a ‘burden.’

The witness is the settler who watches the economic destruction and says nothing, or who themselves benefit from the settler economy. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler consumer who buys the products of the settler economy on indigenous land without personally commanding the destruction.

3.9 Extraction Triad: Indigenous Culture and Religion

The extractor is the settler institution that takes and replaces the indigenous culture and religion. The US boarding school that took the Native American child’s culture and replaced it with Christianity. The Canadian residential school that took the First Nations child’s culture and replaced it with Catholicism or Protestantism. The Australian mission that took the Aboriginal child’s culture and replaced it with Christianity. The South African Dutch Reformed Church that took the Black South African’s culture and replaced it with Afrikaner Christianity. The Israeli state that takes the Palestinian’s culture and replaces it with Hebrew Israeli identity.

The subject conforms by converting, by abandoning the indigenous culture and religion, by performing the settler culture and religion. What is extracted is the indigenous culture and religion itself — the language, the ceremony, the knowledge, the practice. The extraction transfers the indigenous cultural capacity to the settler, with the indigenous reduced to a copy of the settler.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Native American child who lost their culture in the boarding school lost the option to their inheritance, which is to say, lost the option to a self that is not settler-defined. The First Nations child in the residential school lost the same. The Aboriginal child in the Stolen Generations lost the same. The loss compounds across generations, producing the assimilated indigenous who no longer knows their own culture — the very goal of the assimilation

operation.

The witness is the settler who watches the cultural extraction and says nothing, or who themselves practice the settler culture and religion on indigenous land. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler church that receives the converted indigenous as a member.

3.10 Extraction Triad: Indigenous Child for Assimilation

The extractor is the settler state that takes the indigenous child for assimilation. The US state that took Native American children for the boarding schools. The Canadian state that took First Nations children for the residential schools and the Sixties Scoop. The Australian state that took Aboriginal children for the Stolen Generations. The South African state that took Black children for the farm school system. The Israeli state that takes Palestinian children for the Israeli juvenile justice system.

The subject conforms by surrendering the child, by accepting the removal, by signing the consent form (often under duress). What is extracted is the indigenous child itself — the next generation, the carrier of culture, the continuation of the people. The extraction transfers the child from the indigenous family to the settler institution, with the child raised as settler.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Native American parent who lost their child to the boarding school lost the option to parenthood, which is to say, lost the option to a future. The First Nations parent who lost their child to the residential school lost the same. The Aboriginal parent who lost their child to the Stolen Generations lost the same. The loss compounds across generations, producing the missing generations that the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada documented as the core of the settler-colonial project.

The witness is the settler who watches the child extraction and says nothing, or who themselves adopt or foster the indigenous child. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the settler family that receives the indigenous child as a member, the settler school that receives the indigenous child as a student, the settler church that receives the indigenous child as a convert.

Nascent forms of this system include: ‘The frontier’, ‘The pioneer’, ‘Manifest destiny’, ‘The civilising mission’, ‘The empty land doctrine’, ‘Terra nullius’, ‘The settlement’, ‘The settler’, ‘The settler state’, ‘The indigenous problem’, ‘The Indian question’, ‘The demographic threat’, ‘The security fence’, ‘The buffer zone’, ‘The relocation’, ‘The reservation’, ‘The Bantustan’, ‘The native authority’, ‘The trust land’, ‘The protected area’, ‘The boarding school’, ‘The Stolen Generations’, ‘The Sixties Scoop’, ‘Blood quantum’, The Israeli ID system (green, blue, yellow), The Fulani pastoralist-farmer conflict rhetoric, Land grabbing by foreign and domestic agribusiness, Demographic shifts in Plateau State, Urban ‘development’ demolitions.

SECTION 3 · NAIVE APPROACH

3. The Disciplinary Domain

When the ten triads above link into networks, Settler Colonialism scales. The link can be hierarchical (the enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above) or community-based (the witness at one triad becomes the enforcer at another). Both forms are visible in every settler-colonial context. Nigerian readers should recognise the patterns because fledgling versions could emerge in Nigeria if not addressed.

4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars

A Disciplinary Hierarchy is a chain of nested triads. The enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above. Each middle position is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. Settler Colonialism spreads through this form in every settler-colonial context.

Peak Triad-Node

At the peak is the triad where the highest settler authority in the hierarchy enforces on the layer below. In Israel-Palestine, the peak is the Knesset enforcing on the military governor, who enforces on the settlement council, who enforces on the settler, who enforces on the Palestinian. In the United States, the peak is the federal government enforcing on the Bureau of Indian Affairs, which enforces on the tribal council (under BIA supervision), which enforces on the indigenous nation, which enforces on the indigenous person.

In Australia, the peak is the federal government enforcing on the state Aboriginal affairs department, which enforces on the mission manager (historically) or the community council (currently), which enforces on the Aboriginal community, which enforces on the Aboriginal person. In Canada, the peak is the federal government enforcing on the Department of Indian Affairs, which enforces on the band council, which enforces on the First Nation, which enforces on the First Nations person. In pre-1994 South Africa, the peak was the apartheid state enforcing on the Bantu Affairs Department, which enforced on the Bantustan government, which enforced on the homeland citizen, which enforced on the Black South African.

Middle Triad-Nodes

The middle nodes are where the chain's character is clearest. Each middle enforcer is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. The Israeli military governor who kneels for the Knesset in the morning demands kneeling from the settlement council in the afternoon. The BIA official who defers to the federal government in the morning demands deference from the tribal council in the afternoon. The Bantu Affairs commissioner who defers to the apartheid state in the morning demands deference from the Bantustan government in the afternoon.

The middle is where Settler Colonialism reproduces. The indigenous subject of today is the enforcer of tomorrow — as the co-opted tribal council member, the co-opted Bantustan official, the co-opted Palestinian Authority officer. The middle position teaches the subject to want the position above, which means learning to enforce on those below. By the time the indigenous person becomes a co-opted official, they have been disciplined by Settler Colonialism for decades.

Bottom Triad-Node

At the bottom is the triad where the lowest-ranked settler enforcer enforces on the most vulnerable indigenous. The Israeli settler enforcing on the Palestinian farmer. The US rancher enforcing on the Native American elder. The Australian pastoralist enforcing on the Aboriginal community. The Canadian settler enforcing on the First Nations woman. The South African white farmer enforcing on the Black farmworker. The bottom is where the system's violence is most concentrated.

The bottom node is also where the hierarchy meets the community form. The Israeli settler who enforces on the Palestinian farmer is simultaneously the enforcer in the settlement council, where they enforce Settler Colonialism on the new settler. The US rancher who enforces on the Native American elder is simultaneously the enforcer in the county, where they enforce Settler Colonialism on the new white resident. The intersection of hierarchy and community is what makes Settler Colonialism inescapable for the indigenous.

4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network

A Disciplinary Community is a distributed network. There is no peak, no chain of command. There is only circulation. The witness of one Settler Colonialism triad becomes the enforcer, subject, or witness of another. Settler Colonialism spreads laterally through any settler who has witnessed settler enforcement without dissenting.

The Settler Solidarity Networks

The settler solidarity networks circulate Settler Colonialism laterally across the settler population. The Israeli settler movement organises across the West Bank settlements, sharing enforcement techniques. The US militia movement organises across the rural West, sharing anti-indigenous rhetoric. The Australian One Nation movement circulates anti-Aboriginal sentiment. The Canadian settler backlash against reconciliation circulates across the white population. The South African Broederbond (historically) circulated Afrikaner nationalist solidarity across the apartheid state.

The Settler Religious Networks

The settler religious networks circulate Settler Colonialism laterally through theology. The Christian Zionist movement in the United States circulates theological support for Israeli settlement. The Dutch Reformed Church in South Africa (historically) circulated theological support for apartheid. The US Manifest Destiny theology (historically) circulated theological support for westward expansion. The Australian Anglican mission network circulated theological support for the Stolen Generations.

The Settler Academic Networks

The settler academic networks circulate Settler Colonialism laterally through knowledge production. The Israeli academic institution that produces knowledge justifying the occupation. The US academic institution that produced knowledge justifying the frontier. The Australian academic institution that produced knowledge justifying terra nullius. The Canadian academic institution that produced knowledge justifying the residential school. The South African academic institution that produced knowledge justifying apartheid.

The Settler Media Networks

The settler media networks circulate Settler Colonialism laterally through narrative. The Israeli media that narrates the Palestinian as terrorist. The US media that narrates the Native American as savage (historically) or as casino owner (currently). The Australian media that narrates the Aboriginal as welfare dependent. The Canadian media that narrates the First Nations as corrupt. The South African media (under apartheid) that narrated the Black South African as dangerous.

The Settler Legal Networks

The settler legal networks circulate Settler Colonialism laterally through law. The Israeli legal institution that produces the law of the occupation. The US legal institution that produced the law of the frontier (the Marshall Trilogy, the Dawes Act, the Indian Reorganization Act). The Australian legal institution that produced the law of terra nullius (until Mabo). The Canadian legal institution that produced the Indian Act. The South African legal institution that produced apartheid law.

The Settler Family Networks

The settler family networks circulate Settler Colonialism laterally through inheritance. The settler family that takes indigenous land for a farm passes the farm to the settler child, who inherits both the land and the consciousness of the settler. The settler family that adopts an indigenous child raises the child as settler, passing the settler consciousness to the next generation. The settler family network is the most intimate reproducer of Settler Colonialism because it operates in the home.

SECTION 4 · NAIVE APPROACH

4. The Structural Domain

Run the Ship of Theseus test. When the original settler and the original indigenous are dead and replaced, when the original networks are disbanded and reform, what is consistent? What outlives both individuals and groups? What forces new settlers and new indigenous to re-form into the same patterns — not because anyone instructs them to, but because the residue makes any other pattern costly or invisible?

Settler Colonialism leaves all three residues. It is the most total system in the framework because its goal is replacement. Almost every institution in the settler state carries Bureaucracy, Stratification, and Classification from Settler Colonialism simultaneously.

5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures

Settler Colonialism's bureaucracy is the codified settler-indigenous structure. In Israel-Palestine: the Israeli Civil Administration, the ID system (green for West Bank Palestinians, blue for Palestinian citizens of Israel, yellow for Israeli settlers), the permit regime, the settlement registry, the Absentee Property Law 1950 (which allowed the state to seize the property of Palestinians who fled in 1948), the Law of Return 1950 (which grants Israeli citizenship to any Jewish immigrant).

In the United States: the Bureau of Indian Affairs (established 1824), the Indian Reorganization Act 1934, the federal recognition process (which determines which Native American nations are recognised as such), the trust responsibility (which makes the federal government the trustee of Native American land), the tribal court system (which is supervised by the BIA).

In Australia: the Northern Territory Intervention 2007 (which suspended the Racial Discrimination Act in Aboriginal communities), the Aboriginal Land Rights (Northern Territory) Act 1976, the Native Title Act 1993 (which followed the Mabo decision), the Community Development Programme (which requires Aboriginal participants to work for welfare).

In Canada: the Indian Act 1876 (which governs First Nations life), the residential school system (1831-1996), the band council system (imposed by the Indian Act), the missing and murdered Indigenous women inquiry (2016-present). In pre-1994 South Africa: the Bantu Authorities Act 1951, the Group Areas Act 1950, the Population Registration Act 1950, the Pass Laws, the Bantu Education Act 1953, the Promotion of Bantu Self-Government Act 1959. The original authors are dead. The bureaucracy lives.

5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings

Settler Colonialism's stratification is the daily experience of settler-indigenous rank in every institutional encounter. **Settler/indigenous** — the settler ranks above the indigenous in legal standing,

in property rights, in political power, in social recognition. **White/native** — the racialised version of the settler/indigenous ranking.

Civilised/primitive — the moral version, with settler as civilised and indigenous as primitive.

Developed/underdeveloped — the economic version, with settler as developed and indigenous as underdeveloped. **Citizen/subject** — the political version, with settler as citizen of the settler state and indigenous as subject of the settler state.

Legal/illegal occupant — the property version, with settler as legal occupant and indigenous as illegal occupant (the Israeli framing of the Palestinian, the Australian framing of the Aboriginal camp).

Owner/squatter — the same ranking in different language. **Human/terrorist** — the security version, with settler as human and indigenous as terrorist (the Israeli framing of the Palestinian, the US framing of the Native American in the 19th century). The ranking is in the air; it does not need to be announced.

The settler city enforces stratification without anyone issuing an order. The settler lives in the affluent neighbourhood. The indigenous lives in the reservation, the reserve, the Bantustan, the refugee camp, the township. The settler's neighbourhood has the paved road, the water, the electricity, the school. The indigenous's neighbourhood has the dirt road, the water truck, the generator, the underfunded school. The geography is the rank. Challenging the geography is challenging the settler order.

5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions

Settler Colonialism's classification is the set of categorical names that organise every person in the settler state into settler-indigenous categories. **Settler** and **indigenous** — the universal pair, with settler as the legitimate and indigenous as the problem. **White** and **native** — the racialised version.

Legal and **illegal** — the property version, with settler as legal and indigenous as illegal. **Citizen** and **alien** — the political version, with settler as citizen and indigenous as alien. **Owner** and **squatter** — the property version in different language. **Terrorist** and **freedom fighter** — the political version, with settler defining indigenous resistance as terrorism.

Civilised and **primitive** — the moral version. **Modern** and **traditional** — the temporal version.

Developed and **backward** — the economic version. The classification does the work before any individual enforcer shows up. A Palestinian walking into an Israeli checkpoint is already classified; the soldier does not need to demand the ID because the green ID card already carries the classification. A Native American walking into a county office is already classified; the clerk does not need to demand the tribal ID because the racial classification already does the work. Classification is the most universal structural residue.

SECTION 5 · A WARNING FOR NIGERIA

5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual

This section is different from the previous chapters. Settler Colonialism is ascended in the studied cases (Israel-Palestine, US, Australia, Canada, pre-1994 South Africa) but is nascent or fledgling in Nigeria. The framework's point in this chapter is to study how Settler Colonialism has ascended elsewhere as a warning of what the Nigerian fledgling forms could become if not dismantled.

6.1 Canon — Rewriting History in the Studied Cases

Canon is the present belief that the settler-colonial structure has always been so. Each studied case has its own Canon. In Israel-Palestine, the Canon is the phrase 'a land without a people for a people without a land' — the assertion that Palestine was empty before the Zionist settlers arrived. The Canon erases the Palestinian people who had lived on the land for centuries.

In the United States, the Canon is 'manifest destiny' — the assertion that the US was divinely ordained to expand across the continent. The Canon erases the Native American nations who had lived on the land for millennia. The Canon includes the 'empty continent' myth, the 'vanishing Indian' myth, and the 'frontier' as a heroic narrative rather than a colonial operation.

In Australia, the Canon was 'terra nullius' — the legal doctrine that Australia was empty before the British arrived. The doctrine was overturned by the Mabo decision of 1992, but the Canon persists in practice. In Canada, the Canon is 'two founding nations' — the assertion that Canada was founded by the British and the French, excluding the First Nations who had lived on the land for millennia. In South Africa, the Canon was 'separate development' and the 'white man's country' — the assertion that South Africa was a white country with Black labour.

Internalised Domination

Canon produces Internalised Domination because Settler Colonialism produces Stratification. The settler's felt entitlement to the indigenous land is now natural, automatic, unquestionable. The Israeli settler who claims the Palestinian land does not experience this as a demand. They experience it as the natural order. The US rancher who claims the Native American land experiences it the same way. The Australian pastoralist, the Canadian settler, the South African white farmer — all experience their claim to indigenous land as natural.

The settler's entitlement to indigenous labour is natural. The settler's entitlement to indigenous resources is natural. The settler's entitlement to define who is human is natural. Each entitlement grows with repetition. The first time the settler claimed the indigenous land, there was a moment of recognition. The hundredth time, the settler feels outrage at any challenge. The entitlement has been internalised so deeply that its non-fulfilment registers as injury.

Internalised Authority

Canon produces Internalised Authority in the settler enforcer regardless of personal material gain. The settler who polices the indigenous gains nothing material from each individual act of policing. The settler who administers indigenous land gains nothing material from each individual administration. The settler who removes indigenous children gains nothing material from each individual removal. The settler who defines indigenous identity gains nothing material from each individual definition.

The Israeli soldier who checkpoints the Palestinian gains nothing material. The US police officer who arrests the Native American gains nothing material. The Australian police officer who removes the Aboriginal child gains nothing material. The Canadian social worker who takes the First Nations child into care gains nothing material. The South African police officer who enforces the pass law (historically) gained nothing material. The right to enforce feels natural, automatic, and legitimate.

Internalised Oppression

Canon produces Internalised Oppression in the indigenous subject. The indigenous subject is taught that their culture is inferior, that their language is backward, that their land is not really theirs, that their children are better off assimilated. The teaching is silent; it is in the air.

The Native American child in the boarding school who is told ‘kill the Indian, save the man’ is being disciplined by Canon. The First Nations child in the residential school who is told their culture is satanic is being disciplined by Canon. The Aboriginal child in the Stolen Generations who is told their mother does not want them is being disciplined by Canon. The Palestinian citizen of Israel who is told their history is the history of the Jewish people is being disciplined by Canon. Each internalises the impossibility of refusal.

The deepest form of this is the indigenous subject who has absorbed Settler Colonialism so thoroughly that they enforce it on themselves. The assimilated Native American who says ‘I am not really Indian’ because their blood quantum is too low. The assimilated First Nations person who says ‘I am not really Indigenous’ because they did not grow up on the reserve. The assimilated Aboriginal Australian who says ‘I am not really Aboriginal’ because they were raised white. The Palestinian citizen of Israel who says ‘I am an Israeli Arab’ rather than ‘a Palestinian.’ The rebellion-capable subject has become the self-policing subject.

6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality

Practice is the second mechanism of the Ascension Ritual. The interpersonal triad is repeated, again and again, until it becomes habit. The settler enforcer forgets they can choose not to enforce. The indigenous subject forgets they can rebel. The settler witness forgets they can dissent. Patrick Wolfe’s key theoretical contribution is that Settler Colonialism is a **structure**, not an event — it persists across generations because each generation performs it.

Pierre Bourdieu called this *habitus* — the sediment of repeated practice in the body. The settler’s daily drive past the demolished Palestinian village, the settler’s daily purchase of indigenous produce, the indigenous subject’s daily use of the settler language, the indigenous subject’s daily performance of

the settler's identity categories. The body learns. The mind stops questioning.

By the time the settler child is twelve, the settler geography is reflex. They know which neighbourhoods are settler and which are indigenous. They know which schools are settler and which are indigenous. They know which stores serve settlers and which serve indigenous. By adulthood, the settler has performed the settler jurisdiction, property regime, language, education, and family structure triads so many thousands of times that the alternative — recognising the indigenous, returning the land, learning the language — feels like a kind of amputation. The body has been trained. Practice has rewritten reality.

Death — Fast and Slow

Practice produces Death. Fast death in Settler Colonialism is spectacular: the Gaza assault of 2023-2024 with over 35,000 Palestinians killed (the majority women and children) and over 80,000 injured, the majority of buildings in Gaza damaged or destroyed. The Native American genocide in the 19th century, with an estimated 5-15 million deaths through massacre, forced march, starvation, and disease. The Aboriginal Australian genocide, with massacres through the 19th and early 20th centuries.

The Canadian residential school deaths, with over 6,000 confirmed deaths and estimates of 15,000+ when all unmarked graves are found. The South African Sharpeville massacre of 1960 (69 killed), the Soweto uprising of 1976 (176 killed, mostly children). The Rwandan genocide of 1994 (800,000-1,000,000 killed in 100 days), which Mamdani shows was a settler-colonial residue through the Belgian construction of Hutu and Tutsi as racialised categories.

Slow death in Settler Colonialism is quiet. Chronic stress of indigenous life under the settler state — the Palestinian who has not slept properly in years because the next raid is always approaching. The slow death of indigenous languages — the United Nations estimates that over 90% of indigenous languages in the settler states are endangered. The slow death of indigenous religions — the ceremonies that can no longer be performed because the sites are now behind settler fences.

The slow death of indigenous land bases — the reservation that is too small for the population, the reserve that has been eroded by settler encroachment. The slow death of indigenous political structures — the tribal council that is supervised by the BIA, the band council that is supervised by the Department of Indian Affairs, the Palestinian Authority that is supervised by the Israeli state. The missing and murdered Indigenous women in Canada and the US — thousands of women killed or disappeared with little police investigation, because the settler state does not value indigenous life.

The Aboriginal Australian life expectancy gap of 8-10 years. The Palestinian life under occupation, with restricted movement, restricted water, restricted electricity, restricted building materials. The Native American life expectancy gap. The First Nations life expectancy gap. The Black South African life under apartheid. None of these make the news in the settler media. They are Settler Colonialism's quiet tax.

The Warning for Nigeria

The framework's point in this chapter is the warning. The Nigerian fledgling forms identified in Section 2 — the Fulani pastoralist-farmer rhetoric, the agribusiness land grabbing, the demographic shifts in Plateau, the question of who repopulates Boko Haram-liberated territories, the urban demolitions for settler redevelopment — could grow to adulthood and ascend if not dismantled. The studied cases show what that adulthood looks like.

The historical memory traces for the studied cases: for Israel-Palestine, **1948** (the Nakba, the displacement of 700,000 Palestinians) and **1967** (the occupation of the West Bank and Gaza). For the United States, **1830** (the Indian Removal Act) and **1890** (the closing of the frontier, the Wounded Knee massacre). For Australia, **1788** (first settlement) and the early 20th century (the Stolen Generations). For Canada, **1867** (Confederation) and **1880s** (the residential school system). For South Africa, **1652** (Dutch settlement), **1910** (Union), and **1948** (formal apartheid).

Each was a concluded historical event that cannot be retroactively undone. This is why the framework treats Settler Colonialism in these contexts as a concluded historical event whose residue forms Coloniality (Chapter 11). The Nigerian fledgling forms have not yet concluded. They can still be dismantled. The framework's point in this chapter is to give Nigerian readers the analytical tools to recognise the fledgling forms in their own context, before they conclude into a Nigerian Settler Colonialism whose residue would then form a Nigerian Coloniality for centuries to come.

SECTION 6

6. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination

The framework asks two questions of every subject of every ascended matrix. The blanks are for you. They are not rhetorical. This chapter's blanks are different from previous chapters: they ask you to identify the fledgling Settler Colonial forms in your own Nigerian context, so you can recognise the warning signs before they grow.

Question 1: When did you first notice the warning signs?

When did you first notice the warning signs of settler-colonial patterns in your own Nigerian context — the rhetoric of demographic threat, the displacement of communities for 'development,' the assimilationist framing of 'backward' cultures? The moment was: _____. The year was: _____. The place was: _____. The community being displaced or replaced was: _____. The community doing the displacing or replacing was: _____. The framing that justified it was: _____. What you did when you noticed was: _____. What you wish you had done was: _____. The Nigerian fledgling form that this most resembled was (Fulani pastoralist-farmer, agribusiness land grabbing, Plateau demographic shifts, Boko Haram displacement and repopulation, urban demolitions, indigenous/settler framing in Plateau/Kaduna/Taraba): _____.

Question 2: How are the fledgling forms causing harm?

How are the fledgling forms of Settler Colonialism causing harm (slow/fast) in your context — the displaced community, the demolished settlement, the assimilated culture, the language loss, the religious displacement? The form of harm I am most afraid of in my context is (fast/slow): _____. The specific way it is happening is: _____. (For example: the community that was displaced from the land in _____ year and has not returned; the language that my grandparents spoke that I cannot speak because the school taught me to be ashamed of it; the religious practice that my community abandoned because the foreign religion told us it was backward; the urban community demolished for redevelopment whose former residents are now scattered across the city; the rural community whose land was seized for agribusiness whose former residents are now landless.) The matrix's name for what is happening is: _____. My own name for it is: _____.

If you filled in the blanks honestly, you have just located the fledgling Settler Colonial forms in your own Nigerian context. The next time you see the rhetoric of demographic threat, the displacement of a community for 'development,' the assimilationist framing of a 'backward' culture — you will be able to see the fledgling form before it grows. That sight is the beginning of prevention. The framework's point in this warning chapter is to give you the analytical tools to dismantle the fledgling forms before they ascend. Once they ascend, they become Coloniality (Chapter 11), and Coloniality is far harder to

dismantle.

SECTION 7

7. Endnotes & References

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Coming Next

Chapter 11 will take up Coloniality — the system that forms when Invasion (Chapter 9) or Settler Colonialism (Chapter 10) has reached ascension but has ended and was not properly dismantled, so structural residues AND ascension ritual mechanisms were leftover and went on to form their own independent systems: Epistemic Oppression, Linguicism (English), Colorism, Texturism, Colonial Christianity. Coloniality is the residue of concluded invasions. This chapter will be the framework's most directly Nigerian chapter, because Coloniality in Nigeria is the residue of the concluded British colonial invasion.

If you are reading this chapter as part of the framework in progress, the order continues: Chapter 12 is Somatic Normativity, Chapter 13 is Retributivism, Chapter 14 is Amatonormativity, and so on through the Fundamental Matrices. Each chapter follows the same template established in Chapters 2 through 10. The naive approach in the first three domains. The Ascension Ritual in the fourth (or the warning, in this chapter's case). The historical memory trace. The fill-in-the-blank. The endnotes. The pattern is now set.